

WORKING DRAFT · V0.3-BETA · 2026-05-08

Reconnecta

*A regenerative living laboratory at
Óbidos Lagoon, Portugal.*

Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.

— NORBERT ROZTOCKI, FOUNDER

LOCATION

LAND

PROGRAMME

STAGE

OWNER

FOUNDER

Nadadouro, Portugal 4.83 ha (3 parcels) Hotel Rural 3★ · 10 units PIP submitted HOME 4 LIFE LDA [Norbert Roztocki](#)

Executive Summary

Reconnecta is a 4.83-hectare regenerative project under development on the western coast of Portugal, between Óbidos Lagoon and the Atlantic. Its purpose is to prove — at human scale and on a single piece of land — that uncompromising ecological practice and uncompromising quality of life are not opposites. They are the same craft, done well.

The project is organised around three interlocking commitments: a family home, a working ecosystem, and a place where others learn what it took to build it. The hospitality layer — a 10-unit Hotel Rural 3★, currently in the Portuguese pre-permit (PIP) stage — funds the operation. Workshops, residencies and a research programme give it meaning. The land itself — soils, water, oaks, horses, food — is both medium and message.

Reconnecta is being built by Norbert Roztocki and family, with Paweł Sroczyński as project manager. It is not a retreat centre, not a commune, not a brand. It is a place.

This document describes what is known, what is being designed, and what remains to be answered. Open questions are flagged in line as PENDING — ... and registered in §19 so they can be tracked rather than hidden.

Project Roadmap

Reconnecta is being delivered as a seven-stage process. Stage 0 is being finalised now — this whitepaper, the gap registry in §19 and the Regrarians basemap in the public source repository are its outputs. Everything from Stage 1 onward is ahead of us.

#	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	STATUS
0	Holistic Context	Organise everything we know about the place, the people, the constraints and the goals into a single artefact.	IN PROGRESS · FINALISING
1	Conceptual Work	Translate the holistic context into spatial form. First sketches that turn values and constraints into proposed shape on the land.	PENDING
2	Integral Conceptual Sketch	Working architectural and functional form, plus team-building. The shape becomes a working design proposition.	PENDING

#	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	STATUS
3	Technical Conceptual Project	Engineering layer added to the design — structure, systems, materials decisions.	PENDING
4	Construction Documentation	Full building permit and execution drawings.	PENDING
5	Phased Construction	Building. Phased to align with permits, weather, capital cycles.	PENDING
6	Living	Occupancy. The land is in use.	PENDING

The stages are sequential — each one consumes the output of the previous. The current document closes Stage 0 by making the project legible to itself and to anyone joining it.

§ 03

The Holistic Goal

Every design decision in this project is tested against a single sentence — the day Norbert wants this place to make possible:

Wake up, ride on the land, have a swim in a natural lake, meet some artists, have lunch made from locally grown vegetables, meet friends and people coming for the workshop who want to see how a self-sustainable project can exist and function.

Behind that sentence sit three pillars:

QUALITY OF LIFE

Family home. Horses. Creativity. Guests. Community. Nature immersion. Freedom from dependency on external systems.

FORMS OF PRODUCTION

Accommodation revenue. Horsemanship workshops. Ecology and permaculture workshops. Food from the land. Energy from the land. Artist residencies and cultural programming.

FUTURE RESOURCE BASE

Self-sustaining land in 50–100 years. Healthy soil. Biodiverse native ecosystem. A model others can learn from and replicate.

The Holistic Goal is the constitution; everything that follows is implementation.

§ 04

Site & Topography

Location	Nadadouro, Caldas da Rainha municipality
From Óbidos Lagoon	~1,000 m
From Atlantic	~3,000 m
Owned area	4.83 ha across 3 parcels (4.02 + 1.56 + 0.94 ha)
Owner	HOME 4 LIFE LDA · acquired 2019-02-04
Cadastral artigos	3978, 3988, 3994
Adjacent rented	4–5 ha · terms PENDING — see §19, Q20
Total operational	up to 8–10 ha
Zoning	PDM — Espaço Agro-Florestal
Planning framework	Agrotourism DL 39/2008 · Article 61 PDM · accommodation cap ≤ 600 m ² ABC
Topographic survey	TPG Lda (Pedro Agapito), 1:500 scale

Two zones

Upper section (~2 ha). Cleared ex-eucalyptus plantation. Heights 27–37 m. Average gradient ~5% over 200 m horizontal, slope facing south-west — warm, afternoon sun. The planned building zone. Soil is post-eucalyptus: degraded, clay/sand mix, compacted.

Lower section (~2 ha). Biodiverse, established native vegetation (oak, pine, local species). Heights 24–27 m. A seasonal stream runs through it. The PIP documents identify *zonas húmidas* (wetland zones) and multiple *linhas de água*. High ecological value, designated *preserve and enhance*.

Drainage. Upper section drains south-west toward the lower section's stream. Mediterranean–Atlantic hydrology: wet winters, dry summers. This is a design problem — capture, slow, store, distribute — not a resource problem.

Maps & access

PIP submission package includes cadastral plans, topographic survey, satellite aerial overlay, architectural site plans, full N-S and W-E cross-sections. Primary entry: east, from Travessa da Avé Maria. A second entry on the lower section is planned for horse and agricultural traffic, separating guest flows from operational flows.

§ 05

Land History

The land was acquired by HOME 4 LIFE LDA in February 2019 and has been in planning since. What sits on it now is the surface of a much longer story — the BioPiscinas landscape-planning study (Schwarzer & Schwarzer, *Landschaftsplanerische Bewertung*, April 2026) reads the place across three time-scales.

Pre-modern

Systematic deforestation under Roman and Moorish settlement; from the 19th to mid-20th century, intensive viticulture, orchards and small-parcel polyculture shaped the regional mosaic that is still legible today.

Industrial-era trace

The Nadadouro basin saw **brown-coal (lignite) mining** through the 19th and early 20th century, peaking around the World Wars. A 1959 geological map already lists the mine as decommissioned. The artificial drainage ditch that runs through the parcel today is hypothesised by BioPiscinas to date from this mining era — dewatering the natural depression at the foot of the eucalyptus plot. "*Oberflächlich kaum noch etwas zu sehen,*" the report notes — but atypical depressions remain in the topography, and the ditch shapes the hydrology to this day (see §8).

The last twenty years on this parcel

Aerial-photo time-series cited in the BioPiscinas study:

YEAR	DOMINANT COVER
2006	Forestry plantations dominate
2018	Sand-fields / freshly growing eucalyptus on the SE plot
2022	Heath species (<i>Ulex europaeus latebracteatus</i>) dominate northern plots
2023	Planted forestry trees becoming dominant again

The report flags that *"intensive Eingriffe wie Baumpflanzungen und Fällen der Bäume sowie Umackern des Bodens"* — repeated planting, felling and ploughing within a 20-year window — has consequences for both biodiversity and the water balance of the place.

Current state at fieldwork (April 2026)

The eucalyptus stand has already been cut. Small native oaks and cork oaks are regenerating on the N/NW slope. The understorey of the eastern oak grove was recently cut as a fire-prevention action — BioPiscinas flags this as counter-productive (cleared dry undergrowth propagates fire faster than structured moist undergrowth; see §7).

The constant

"Einzig konstantes Element in der Landschaft ist der naturnahe Waldbestand auf dem Grundstück am Ostrand" — across all four aerial epochs, the only stable feature is the near-natural oak forest on the eastern edge of the parcel. That stand is the project's deepest ecological asset.

OPEN

- Q15 — Exact date of the eucalyptus felling (between 2018 and 2023, not yet pinned) and whether stumps were chemically treated.
- Q29 — Who held the land before HOME 4 LIFE LDA (2019); who planted the 2006 forestry stand.

§ 06

People & Decisions

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Investor & strategic owner	Norbert Roztocki	Active
Project manager	Paweł Sroczyński	Active · PENDING — Q8 formal scope
Architect	João Carlos Fonseca Jorge (OA #18423)	Engaged
Topographic surveyor	TPG Lda	Engaged
Biologist	Engaged	Survey in progress

ROLE	PERSON	STATUS
Operational manager	—	VACANT · PENDING — Q9 critical hire
Family	Kamila + two children (12, 14)	Roles partial · PENDING — Q7

Norbert

Investor, kitesurfer, natural-horsemanship practitioner. Holds final strategic and financial authority. Present 6–8 months per year — strongest in the shoulder seasons (February–May, September–November). Away during winter and peak summer. Currently committing about 12 hours per week to project planning.

Kamila

Spouse, partner, parent. Functional role inside the operation is not yet defined. Co-decision-maker? Active on-site? The project's day-to-day stability — particularly during Norbert's absences — depends on this answer. PENDING — Q7

The vacancy that runs the place

A multi-enterprise operation (hospitality + horses + agriculture + workshops) requires presence 365 days a year. The brief: bilingual (Portuguese plus English/Polish), competent across horses, agriculture and hospitality. This person does not yet exist in the org. Recruitment in rural Portugal for this profile is itself a project. PENDING — Q9, Q10

Succession

Two paths held open: the children take over in time, or independent professional leadership succeeds the founder. Decided later, not now.

§ 07

Climate

The BioPiscinas study (April 2026) provides the first quantitative climate frame for the parcel.

PARAMETER	VALUE
Köppen classification	Csb — Mediterranean, dry-cool summers, Atlantic
Annual precipitation	694 mm

PARAMETER	VALUE
Mean annual temperature	~21 °C
Cold-month night average	7 °C
Warm-month night average	17 °C
Highest recorded	39 °C (September 2016)
Lowest recorded	8 °C (February 2016)
Frost	"Frost ist selten" — rare
Wind	"weht oft sehr kräftig" — often strong; direction unspecified
Dry season	> 3 months in summer; evaporation exceeds precipitation

Fire risk — counter-intuitive finding

The BioPiscinas report contains a specific warning relevant to the parcel: clearing the understorey of the eastern oak grove, done as a "fire-prevention" measure before fieldwork, *"führt genau zum Gegenteil von dem, was mit der Aktion gemeint war, zu mehr Feuergefahr"* — leads to *more* fire risk, not less. Dry, exposed fuel propagates fire faster than structured moist undergrowth. This is consequential for any future fire plan, and contradicts the intuitive but mistaken practice common in the region.

STILL OPEN

- Q4 — Frost-day count per year (only "rare" so far)
- Q5 — Prevailing wind direction and peak speeds
- Q6 — PMDFCI fire-risk classification for this parcel + wildfire history within ~5 km

§ 08

Water

The BioPiscinas study reframes the hydrology of the parcel. What earlier documents called a "seasonal stream" is, in fact, a centuries-old artificial drainage ditch dewatering a natural depression at the foot of the eucalyptus plot — *"die auf dem Grundstück vorhandene Senke war einst ein See oder ein Sumpfgebiet."* Without the ditch the depression would have no outflow. This shifts the design vocabulary from "manage a stream" to "decide whether to keep dewatering, or restore the lake."

What the site is

SOURCE	STATUS	NOTES
Municipal mains	Available	Reliable year-round; PIP confirms connection. Connection obligation likely applies for tourist-grade potable use
Rainwater storage	Planned	Buffer + capture
Artificial drainage ditch	Existing, anthropogenic	Centuries old. Cuts through the oak hill, dewateres the depression. Possibly mining-era (see §5)
Natural depression / former lake	Latent	Former lake/swamp at the foot of the eucalyptus plot. Shallow groundwater near surface year-round
Borehole	Planned	High-quality drinking water · APA licence PENDING — Q12 · hydrogeology warning below
Plant-based wastewater treatment	Recommended (BioPiscinas)	Pflanzenkläranlagen — reused on tree cultivation

What the field signals confirm

- **Indicator species.** *Potamogeton polygonifolius* (a perennial wetland species) is present in the southwestern ditch. "*Diese Art kann auf Dauer nur in naturnahen Feuchtgebieten gedeihen*" — it can only persist where high groundwater is permanent.
- **Aerial-photo evidence.** Bright green vegetation in the southern depression visible in **September 2018** and **July 2022** — both deep into the dry season — confirms that near-surface water persists year-round, not just in wet winters. Partial answer to Q13: the depression doesn't go fully dry; the ditch's own summer flow is still unconfirmed.

What BioPiscinas proposes

- **Weir on the drainage ditch** to raise the water level in the depression and restore it toward its historic lake/swamp condition. Could supply horse pastures and gardens by indirect (groundwater) irrigation, possibly without dedicated summer irrigation.
- **Five water uses to balance:** households, horse husbandry, garden, natural vegetation, plus reuse of treated wastewater.
- **Town-water for potable;** plant-based wastewater treatment for irrigation; weir-controlled groundwater for pasture and garden.

Geothermal / mineral-water context

Nadadouro lies on the **Caldas thermal region** (Caldas da Rainha basin = a salt-dome subsidence basin formed by the Dagorda Formation). Exploration drillings between Nadadouro and Foz do Arelho document **NaCl-bearing mesothermal water** at 22–28 °C, classified as *ocorrências* (not concessions). The hottest layers sit > 500–800 m deep — drilling cost is the limiter. The PDM of Caldas da Rainha lists Nadadouro–Foz do Arelho as a **zone with hydrothermal potential**.

Hydrogeology warning from BioPiscinas: deep wells on this site are likely to strike highly mineralised, probably non-potable water. Commission a hydrological expert opinion *before* contracting a driller. Any deep drilling needs DGEG (Direção-Geral de Energia e Geologia) authorisation.

STILL OPEN

- **Water demand.** No formal demand calculation yet. Needs livestock numbers, irrigated areas, accommodation capacity. Downstream of **PENDING — Q16, Q17**
- **APA borehole licence.** Application not yet initiated. **PENDING — Q12**
- **Decision needed.** Restore the depression to a wetland (close or weir the ditch) or maintain the dewatering and design the lower section as drained pasture? This is a constitutional question for the project.

§ 09

Soil & Ecosystems

The BioPiscinas study replaces the earlier qualitative model of the soil and the vegetation with a Natura 2000-keyed reading of the place.

Two-zone geological / soil model

ZONE	SUBSTRATE	POTENTIAL NATURAL VEGETATION	NATURA 2000
Eastern hill (eastern oak plot + part of the eucalyptus plot)	Dagorda marl, limestone, clay, dolomite — basic soils	Portuguese oak (<i>Quercus faginea</i>) forest	9240 — Iberian Q. faginea / Q. canariensis forests

ZONE	SUBSTRATE	POTENTIAL NATURAL VEGETATION	NATURA 2000
Valley plots (lower section, north and south)	Plio-Pleistocene sands, sandstones, gravels — Astian Complex (Nadadouro / Águas Santas) — acidophilic, podzolised	Cork oak (<i>Quercus suber</i>) forest — not preserved on the parcel	9330 (potential); current cover is 4030 / 4030pt3 dry/Atlantic gorse heath, the degraded successor stage

Important correction to earlier descriptions of this project. The native vegetation of the *lower* section is *not* preserved oak/pine — the cork oak forest that should be there has been replaced by *Ulex europaeus latebracteatus* gorse heath, the degradation stage that follows cork-oak loss. The well-preserved oak stand sits on the *eastern hill*, and is *Quercus faginea* (not cork oak) — a regionally rare and Natura-2000-listed habitat of significant conservation value.

Habitats inventoried by BioPiscinas

CODE	HABITAT	WHERE ON PARCEL
9240	Iberian <i>Quercus faginea</i> / <i>Q. canariensis</i> forests	Eastern oak hill
6410pt4	Portugal-endemic rush meadows with <i>Juncus valvatus</i> — relict	Wetland fringe (peripheral)
6430pt2	Perennial hygrophilic tall-herb vegetation on permanently moist soils	Wetland fringe
4030 / 4030pt3	Dry European / Atlantic gorse heaths	Across valley plots — degraded successor of cork-oak forest

Red-List and notable flora

- *Carduus lusitanicus broteroi* (Least Concern)
- *Cheirolophus uliginosus* (Near Threatened) — peat-bog indicator
- *Quercus extremadurensis* — RELAPE-listed (Portuguese protected species)
- ~95 vascular plant species inventoried in the BioPiscinas vegetation survey

Confirmed invasives — small populations, eradicate now

- *Acacia spec.*
- *Carpobrotus edulis*

- *Conyza spec.*
- *Cortaderia sellowiana*

BioPiscinas urges **immediate eradication** while populations remain localised — a window that closes fast on this kind of substrate.

Ecological connectivity

The parcel sits in the **Lagoa de Óbidos catchment landscape**, a RAMSAR-protected wetland since early 2025. The eastern *Q. faginea* hill is therefore not just a local asset — it is a regionally rare, Natura-2000-listed habitat in a Ramsar-grade landscape. Whatever is built here lives next to that ecosystem.

The wider regional context includes **laurel forest** (*Laurus nobilis*, **Natura 2000 priority habitat 5230**) as a relict palaeo-subtropical / Tertiary flora endemic to the Caldas da Rainha area (with *Prunus lusitanica*, *Myrica faya*) — not directly on the parcel but adjacent.

SOIL CHEMISTRY & FAUNA — STILL OPEN

The BioPiscinas study works from lithological inference, not laboratory analysis. **No formal soil tests** (pH, organic matter, NPK, heavy metals, compaction) have been done on the parcel. The PIP's declaration that the agricultural area is livre de contaminação química is a legal statement, not a lab result.

- Q14 — Soil-test campaign with committed timeline. Required before any food-bearing planting.
- Fauna survey (birds, reptiles, amphibians, invertebrates) is still missing — BioPiscinas covered flora and habitat only.
- *Juncus valvatus* (the Portuguese endemic for habitat 6410pt4) was not yet documented on-parcel; a targeted survey could change the habitat status.

§ 10

Architecture & Buildings

Programme (per PIP)

Hotel Rural 3★ — formal classification under Portuguese rural-tourism law. Ten units total, built across a main building and two secondary buildings.

Main building	Ground + 1st floor — 7 double rooms with private bathrooms
Secondary building A	Additional units

Secondary building B	Additional units
Total ABC (tourist)	600 m ² (legal max under Article 61 PDM)
Building footprint	560 m ²
Basement	Covered guest parking, breakfast room, staff areas, technical installations
Roof	Green roof (confirmed in PIP plans)

In addition: family home, stables, atelier/workshop complex, and ancillary outbuildings — see §20.

Status

- **Architect:** João Carlos Fonseca Jorge, OA #18423 (Serra d'El-Rei). Professional indemnity confirmed (Ageas Portugal, policy #008410215055, €50k cover).
 - **Submission:** PIP submitted to Caldas da Rainha Câmara Municipal, January 2026.
 - **Stage:** Pre-permit information request. Awaiting municipal response.
 - **Risk:** Critical-path gate for construction. Rural Portuguese cycles run 6–18 months.
- PENDING — Q28** — contingency plan for 12-month delay.

Design principles

All buildings designed for **off-grid operation from day one**, with grid available as backup. Passive design first; technical systems sized to a load that has not yet been calculated (§10). Materials and detail follow the visual language collected on the Miro reference board (§13).

§ 11

Energy

Position: Start grid-connected → transition to fully off-grid (solar + wind + biomass).

Assets: ~300+ days of sun per year, coastal wind, an obvious south-west building aspect. The PIP shows a *central fotovoltaica* on the site plan. Infrastructure connections from Travessa da Avé Maria provide the backup grid path during build-out.

REQUIRED TO SIZE THE SYSTEM

- Q24 — Total electrical load (kW/kWh per day) at full operation
- Battery storage capacity, inverter spec, redundancy
- Phasing timeline (which buildings come online off-grid first)

- Capital and ongoing maintenance budget

Until the load calculation lands, the energy section is a principle without a plan.

§ 12

Animals

ANIMAL	NUMBERS	NOTES
Horses (Lusitano)	up to 6	Native Portuguese breed, climate-adapted. Starting from zero — infrastructure first.
Chickens	TBD	Pest management + eggs
Dogs	1+	Property security and companionship
Goats	1–2	Browsing in degraded zones
Bees	Yes	Pollination + honey
Cow	Future	If space and capacity allow

No horse sales. Revenue from the equine layer is experiential — workshops in natural horsemanship — not livestock trade.

Grazing

Rotational paddocks across the lower section and rented land. Move horses between zones based on land condition. Full division design (paddock count, rotation intervals, rest periods) lands once carrying capacity is sized against climate and water data — downstream of §6 and §7.

A **round pen** is required for natural-horsemanship workshops; siting depends on soil drainage and proximity to the stables.

§ 13

Plants & Food Production

Philosophy. Full organic. No synthetic fertilisers. No synthetic plant-protection products. Ever. *Non-negotiable.*

System. Permaculture-based food forest plus kitchen garden. The food forest oriented toward perennial resilience; the kitchen garden toward family food sovereignty.

Fruit trees (confirmed viable for Atlantic Portugal): lemon, orange, cherry, apple, fig, peach.

Vegetables: carrot, salad, diverse mix.

Sequencing. Garden siting is deliberately not yet fixed. It happens *after* the water design (§7) and access design (§3), because correct sequence beats clever placement. Same principle governs the post-eucalyptus zone: pioneer species and soil remediation precede food-bearing planting by several seasons.

Goal. Family food sovereignty first; surplus to local community and (long-term) restaurant supply second.

§ 14

Aesthetic Direction

The visual constitution of the project lives on a Miro board curated by Norbert under the working title *taipa house / clay*. It is organised by category — **architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape, stables** — and represents the language the buildings, interiors and landscape should speak.

Visual reference (printed version): the board is interactive on the web edition of this document at enklava.co/projects/reconnecta. It contains category-organised image clusters covering architecture, mass and elevation, roofs, kitchen, dining, atelier, sauna and wellness, materials, installations, outdoor kitchen, landscape and stables.

Section in progress. Below: the categories that will receive their own page in the published whitepaper — one tile, one paragraph, one decision per category (what is being carried across, what is being left behind). Tiles remain as placeholders to mark the work still ahead.

ARCHITECTURE
MASS & ELEVATION
ROOFS
KITCHEN
DINING
ATELIER
SAUNA · WELLNESS
MATERIALS
INSTALLATIONS
OUTDOOR KITCHEN
LANDSCAPE

§ 15

Economy & Funding

Revenue streams (named, not yet modelled)

STREAM	STAGE	NOTES
Hotel Rural 3★ accommodation	Near-term primary	10 units, short and longer stays
Natural-horsemanship workshops	Near-term	Norbert's core expertise — immediate asset
Ecology / permaculture workshops	Near-term	Norbert's network
Restaurant / food service	Long-term	Land-to-table, post-stabilisation
Artist residencies & cultural	Long-term	Mission, not margin
Licensing of replicable model	Aspirational	Geographic franchise

Financial position

Current revenue	Zero — fully in investment / build phase
Funding source	Norbert's personal company. No external investors. No bank financing.
Operating entity	HOME 4 LIFE LDA (Portuguese commercial Lda., NIPC 513229477) — PENDING — Q18 reconcile with nonprofit framing, and with Moveart, GmbH named as Auftraggeber on the B
Build budget (next 12 months)	€300,000 – €400,000
Active costs	Architects, consultants, biologist, project management

Budget vs. scope — open tension

A single off-grid-ready accommodation unit in Portugal currently costs €60–80k. Ten units plus main house plus stables plus infrastructure plus water plus energy plus access — at credible 2026 costs — sits closer to €800k–€1m+. The €300–400k figure for the next 12 months is therefore either a phase-1 number (and the rest of the programme is on a multi-year capital plan) or scope must be staged more aggressively. Either way: an honest financial model with phasing is required before construction commitment. **PENDING — Q16, Q17**

Grants — opportunities not yet engaged

- Portugal PEPAC 2023–2027 (CAP successor): agroforestry, agrotourism, young farmers
- LIFE Programme (EU): nature and biodiversity
- EEA Grants (Norway / Iceland / Liechtenstein): conservation
- Portuguese environmental funds: habitat restoration

Insurance

Architect's professional indemnity is in place. Property, guest liability, employer liability, equine/workshop liability — none yet planned. Six horses, workshop participants, visiting children: meaningful exposure. **PENDING — Q19**

§ 16

Vision: Five and Ten Years

Five years

Family home occupied. Horses on the land. Partners, friends and visitors living on-site short or medium term. Cultural activities running — artist residencies, music, gatherings. A local community hub where people from different sectors meet and connect.

Ten years

Same vision, deepened. Cycles and processes stable. Community settled. The core principle holds: *co-existing with nature, on independent food and independent energy, in collaboration with local communities and neighbours.*

Lifestyle pattern

- 6–8 months per year on the land
- Most productive shoulder seasons: February–May, September–November
- Away during winter and peak summer

Financial posture

Nonprofit framing. Self-sustaining after the investment phase. Not a profit centre. Open to biodiversity-focused conservation partners.

§ 17

Reference Projects

A March 2026 review benchmarked Reconnecta against ten Portuguese precedents:

PROJECT	LUXURY	OFF-GRID	RESEARCH	COMMUNITY	EDUCATION
Tamera	—	✓	★	★	★
Quinta do Rabaçal	★	★	—	○	—
Vale das Estrelas	★	★	—	—	—
Terra Sangha	✓	✓	★	✓	✓
Terra Alta	—	✓	✓	✓	★
A Quinta da Lage	—	✓	—	★	✓
Vale Ondula	—	✓	✓	★	✓
Quinta do Vale	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Orange Eco Land	○	✓	—	✓	—
Tinhela610	★	✓	—	—	—
Reconnecta	★	★	★	★	★

The empty space. No single project in Portugal currently does what Reconnecta proposes. The luxury layer, the research layer, the community layer and the education layer all exist — but separately. Reconnecta sits at their intersection. That space, in the Portuguese market, is genuinely empty.

Closest references by axis: Luxury + off-grid → Quinta do Rabaçal, Vale das Estrelas, Tinhela610. Research + living lab → Tamera (water systems, 30 years of data), Terra Sangha. Community + education → Terra Alta, A Quinta da Lage, Vale Ondula.

Values & Principles

Collaboration	The project is built, run and evolved through human partnership. Non-negotiable.
Natural alignment	Work with what is here — local conditions, local species, local community. No imposed systems.
Organic absolute	No synthetic fertilisers or plant-protection products. Ever.
Regeneration over productivity	Nonprofit framing removes profit pressure. Focus: biodiversity and ecosystem health.
Community as infrastructure	Neighbours = security network when Norbert is absent. Mutual aid. Shared machinery.
Non-dogmatic	No single -ism. Permaculture, biodynamics, organic agriculture — full deck of cards.

Non-negotiables: the land, and the approach.

Open Questions

The diagnostic captured a strong qualitative picture. The follow-up below is the minimum information needed to convert the picture into a credible roadmap. Tags: *blocking* (no design possible without) or *important* (need but parallelisable).

● Blocking — climate & geography

- Q1 Annual rainfall (mm/year) and monthly distribution
- Q4 Frost days per year, by month
- Q5 Prevailing wind directions and speeds
- Q6 Wildfire history + PMDFCI fire-risk classification

● Blocking — people & operations

- Q7 Kamila's role
- Q8 Paweł's status, scope, authority
- Q9 Operational-manager budget, salary, housing, search timeline

- Q10 Who manages during 4–6-month absences
- Q11 Labour budget beyond manager role

● **Blocking — water & soil**

- Q12 APA borehole licence — applied for?
- Q13 Stream summer behaviour
- Q14 Formal soil tests — commitment + target date
- Q15 Eucalyptus removal date and stump treatment

● **Blocking — finance & legal**

- Q16 Projected annual operating costs at full operation
- Q17 Occupancy rate and nightly-rate assumptions
- Q18 Legal structure: HOME 4 LIFE LDA (PT Lda., land-holder) vs. Moveart GmbH (DE — named as client by BioPiscinas) vs. stated nonprofit framing
- Q19 Insurance — current and planned
- Q20 Lease terms for the rented 4–5 ha

● **Blocking — fire & safety**

- Q21 Fire management plan — firebreaks, fire-safe water reserve, emergency vehicle access
- Q22 PMDFCI high-fire-risk zone designation

● **Important**

- Q23 Accommodation unit detail beyond PIP — layout, materials, target price
- Q24 Total expected electrical load (kW/kWh per day)
- Q25 Sewage/wastewater plan — composting / wetland / septic mix
- Q26 Top-3 priorities for first 12 months
- Q27 Minimum viable version of the project
- Q28 Contingency if PIP delayed 12 months
- Q29 Physical work undertaken since 2019 acquisition

Of 29 original follow-up questions, the PIP package answered or partially answered 7. Sixteen blocking questions remain. A focused follow-up session with Norbert addressing Q1–Q22 unlocks roadmap drafting.

Appendix — Wish List

Norbert's full programme, submitted 2026-03-30 (translated from Polish). Carried here intact — this is the long list, against which scope is staged.

INDEPENDENT ENERGY

Solar panels. Fireplace with water jacket. Three wells. Site-wide water installation.

HALL / WORKSHOP COMPLEX

Trampolines. Storage for excavator, tractor with front loader, mower. Hay storage. Sculpture atelier. Carpentry workshop.

BUILDINGS

Several tiny houses (accommodation). Yoga hall / multi-use space. Shared outdoor kitchen. Paddock.

ACTIVITIES & INFRASTRUCTURE

Site-wide communication. Site-wide lighting. Ski jump / jump ramp. Zip line. Treehouse. Horse trail. Entry gate as sculpture / landmark installation.

SERVICE & GUEST FACILITIES

Five-car garage. Kite equipment room (washing, drying). Outdoor hot shower. En-suite rooms with wardrobes. Multi-functional salon for concerts and performances.

MAIN HOUSE

Mosquito nets and covered porches. Large laundry near kitchen (with view, wardrobe, mangle). Wardrobe at entrance. Exercise / music room (Kamila's). Wood-burning oven plus bread oven. EMF-free zone. Brushed-oak floors.

GARDEN & PERMACULTURE

Greenhouse. Root cellar. Hidden room. Fruit trees (apple, orange, lemon, peach, fig).

ANIMALS & EQUESTRIAN

Four horses (later six). Natural shelters. Paddock and round pen. Horse trail.

OTHER ANIMALS

Chickens. Dogs. Bees.

SAUNA & WELLNESS SPA

Several natural ponds (cold and warm, varying depths). Massage room. Wood-fired sauna.